Al Haj Murad Ebrahim

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Al Haj Murad Ebrahim

Al Haj Murad Ebrahim (born October 2, 1949) is a Filipino Moro revolutionary leader, politician, and the founding chairman of the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF) following the death of Salamat Hashim. He is the first Chief Minister of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), playing a central role in the transition from armed struggle to autonomous governance and development in the Bangsamoro region. <ref name="milf2020">Moro Islamic Liberation Front. *Leadership Profile: Al Haj Murad Ebrahim*. MILF Official Website, 2020.</ref><ref name="usip2020">United States Institute of Peace. *The Bangsamoro Transition and Governance under Murad Ebrahim*. USIP, 2020.</ref>

Early Life and Education

- Murad Ebrahim was born in Barangay Pandan, Cotabato City, to a Maranao family with deep Islamic roots.
- He studied at local Madrasah schools and later pursued higher education in Islamic studies, political science, and leadership development.
- His early exposure to the Moro struggle and Islamic scholarship shaped his commitment to Moro self-determination and governance.<ref name="milf2020" />

MILF Leadership

- Following the death of MILF founder Salamat Hashim in 2003, Murad Ebrahim was appointed chairman of the MILF.
- Under his leadership, the MILF continued to pursue the goal of Moro autonomy while engaging in sustained peace negotiations with the Philippine government.
- Murad emphasized discipline, ideological coherence, and institution-building within the MILF, preparing the organization for political participation and governance.<ref name="milf2020" />

Role in the Bangsamoro Peace Process

- Murad Ebrahim played a pivotal role in negotiating the Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB) signed in 2014 between the MILF and the Philippine government.
- He coordinated with the Bangsamoro Transition Commission to draft the Bangsamoro Organic Law, which laid the legal framework for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao.
- Murad's leadership ensured that the transition process balanced security, governance, and the preservation of Moro culture and identity.<ref name="usip2020" />

Chief Minister of BARMM

- On February 22, 2019, Murad Ebrahim was officially appointed as the first Chief Minister of BARMM following the ratification of the Bangsamoro Organic Law.
- As Chief Minister, he oversees the Bangsamoro Transition Authority, regional governance, economic development programs, education initiatives, and the implementation of Sharia-compliant laws in the region.
- His administration emphasizes reconciliation, post-conflict rehabilitation, and the integration of former combatants into society.<ref name="milf2020" /><ref name="usip2020" />

Vision and Legacy

- Murad Ebrahim is recognized for transforming the MILF from an armed separatist movement into a political and governance-oriented organization.
- He advocates for a peaceful, autonomous, and development-oriented Bangsamoro region while preserving Islamic culture and Maranao traditions.
- His leadership symbolizes the success of Moro self-determination through political negotiation, institution-building, and regional autonomy.<ref name="milf2020" /><ref name="usip2020" />

References

<references> <ref name="milf2020">Moro Islamic Liberation Front. *Leadership Profile: Al Haj Murad Ebrahim*. MILF Official Website, 2020. https://www.luwaran.com</ref> <ref name="usip2020">United States Institute of Peace. *The Bangsamoro Transition and Governance under Murad Ebrahim*. USIP, 2020. https://www.usip.org/publications/2020/02/bangsamoro-transition-and-governance-under-murad-ebrahim</ref> </references>

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